

Asia



The world's largest continent, Asia extends from the Arctic to the equator and from the Mediterranean to the Pacific. The first complex civilization arose in Asia, in ancient Mesopotamia (present-day Iraq), as did all the world's major religions.

Turkey



This secular republic bridging Europe and Asia emerged from the ashes of the Ottoman Empire.

667 BCE The city of **Byzantium** is founded by Greek colonists from Megara.

330 CE **Byzantium is refounded** by Emperor Constantine I as Nova Roma, the new capital of the eastern Roman Empire, and is later renamed Constantinople.

1453 **Constantinople is seized** by the Ottoman Turks and renamed Istanbul, becoming the capital of their empire.

1500s **Ottoman Empire** reaches its peak under Sultan Suleyman I, controlling much of southeast Europe, the Middle East, and North Africa.

1821 **Greek War of Independence** begins.

1832 **Greece is granted** independence by the Treaty of Constantinople.

1853–56 **Crimean War** with Russia, won by the Ottomans with foreign aid.

1908 **The Young Turk Revolution** sees parliament reinstated, as discontent with the Sultan's rule grows.

1911 **Ottomans are defeated** by Italy and are forced out of Libya. Albania declares its independence.

1914 **Ottoman Empire** enters World War I on the side of the Central Powers.

1915 **Approximately 800,000** Armenians are massacred by Turkish authorities.

1920 Following defeat in World War I, the Ottoman Empire is broken up, Turkey is forced to sign the Treaty of Sèvres, which includes the establishment of independent Armenian and Kurdish states, and pay reparations. A war of independence is launched.

1923 **Sultan Muhammad VI** is deposed, and Turkey is declared a republic with Kemal Atatürk as president and Ankara as its new capital. Treaty of Lausanne ends war with Allies, replacing the Treaty of Sèvres. Under a forced exchange, 1.3 million Greeks leave Turkey and 400,000 Turks leave Greece.

1924 **Religious courts** abolished.

1928 **Islam no longer** state religion.

1934 **Women given** the vote.

1938 **President Atatürk** dies. Succeeded by İsmet İnönü.

1945 **Turkey joins UN.**

1952 **Joins NATO.**

1960 **Army stages coup** against ruling Democratic Party and suspends National Assembly.

1961 **Turkey returns** to civilian rule under a new constitution.

1963 **Association agreement** with the European Economic Community (EEC).

1974 **Turkish forces invade** northern Cyprus in response to intercommunal strife between Greek and Turkish populations on the island.

1980 **Martial law** is imposed after a coup.

1982 **New constitution** approved by referendum.

1983 **General election** won by Turgut Özal's ANAP (Motherland Party).

1984 **Turkey recognizes** Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus. Kurdish separatist PKK (Kurdistan Workers' Party) launches guerrilla war in southeast.

1987 **Turkey applies** to join EEC.

1990 **US-led coalition** launches air strikes on Iraq from Turkish bases.

1991 **Elections won by DYP** (True Path Party). Süleyman Demirel premier.

1992 **Joins Black Sea Alliance.**

1993 **Demirel elected president.** Tansu Çiller becomes DYP leader and heads coalition.

1995 **Major offensive** is launched against Kurdish guerrillas in the southeast. Çiller coalition collapses and Islamist Welfare Party (RP) wins election, but center-right DYP-ANAP coalition takes office.

1996 **RP leader** Necmettin Erbakan heads first Islamist government since 1923.

1997 **Mesut Yılmaz reappointed** to head minority ANAP government.

1998 **RP is banned** by constitutional court. Mesut Yılmaz resigns as prime minister after corruption allegations. He is replaced by Bülent Ecevit.

1999 **Democratic Left Party (DSP)** wins most seats in general election. Captured Kurdish guerrilla leader Abdullah Öcalan sentenced to death. His sentence is later commuted to life imprisonment. İzmit earthquake kills 14,000.

2000 **National Assembly refuses** to reelect Demirel for a second term. He is replaced by Ahmet Necdet Sezer.

2001 **Acute financial crisis.** Prisoners and their relatives die in hunger strikes over conditions in high-security prisons.

2002 **Islamist Justice Party (AK)** wins landslide victory in elections. Abdullah Gül becomes prime minister.

2003 **Laws are passed** easing restrictions on the use of the Kurdish language. AK leader Recep Tayyip Erdoğan becomes prime minister after entering parliament through a by-election.

2007 **Turkish-Armenian** community leader Hrant Dink is assassinated.

2007 **The religious AK party** wins elections. Abdullah Gül becomes president.

2008 **President Gül** signs constitutional amendments rescinding a ban on the wearing of Islamic headscarves by women in universities.

2010 **A court in Istanbul** indicts 200 military officers for plotting to overthrow the government. In a referendum, voters back reforms to give the government increased power over army and judiciary.

«78–79 Bronze Age Collapse

«98–99 The Greeks in Asia

«198–99 The Byzantine Empire

«246–47 The Ottoman Empire

Georgia



A small ex-Soviet state in the Caucasus plagued by civil war since gaining independence.

300s BCE **First records** of a Georgian kingdom (of Kartli) after Alexander the Great's conquest of the Persian Empire.

318 CE **Georgia is converted** to Christianity. Over the following 300 years a conflict between Byzantium and Persia leads to the division of the country.

1014 **King Bagrat III** dies after uniting eastern and western Georgia. A golden age follows during the reign of Queen Tamara (1184–1213).

1236 **The Mongols conquer** eastern Georgia, although the western territory of Imeretia remains independent.

1453 **The fall** of Constantinople leaves Georgia isolated from western Christianity. Muslim invaders partition the country.

1783 **Russia guarantees** its independence, but Persia invades Georgia in 1795.

1801 **Russia annexes** Persian-ruled provinces of Kartlia and Kakhetia.

1810 **Western Georgia**, occupied by the Ottomans, is annexed by the Russians.

1826–28 **Russia again defeats** Persia in a war over Georgia.

1864 **Georgian peasants receive** limited freedoms.

1881 **A policy of russification** leads to an increase in radicalism.

1918 **Georgia proclaims** its independence under a Menshevik government and is briefly partly occupied by UK forces.

1921 **The Red Army** invades Georgia, ordered in by Joseph Stalin, despite a treaty of recognition between the two countries.

1922–36 **Georgia is incorporated** into the Transcaucasian Soviet Federative Socialist Republic (TSFSR).

1989 **Pro-independence riots** in Tbilisi are put down by Soviet troops.

TURKISH STATESMAN (1881–1938)

MUSTAFA KEMAL ATATÜRK

The father of the modern Republic of Turkey, Mustafa Kemal forged a secular state from the ashes of the Ottoman Empire, leading the fight against the post-World War I settlement imposed by the Allies and overthrowing the sultan. As president, Kemal introduced a European-style legal system and disestablished Islam as the state religion.

Kemal introduced surnames as part of his Westernizing agenda, and in 1934 he took the name Atatürk, which means "father of the Turks." He is still revered by many Turks as the man who restored pride to a shattered nation.

